

Canadian Community Health Survey (CCHS)

Annual component

Complement to the user guide

2022 Public Use Microdata file

June 2025



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Canada

The following document is a complement to the 2022 Canadian Community Health Survey (CCHS) Microdata User Guide and presents the approach used to transform the 2022 Master file into a Public Use Microdata File (PUMF). Note that CCHS PUMFs are only comprised of the content of the master file and excludes any Rapid Response content, sub-samples, or sample buy-ins. For more information on these types of content, see the main CCHS user guide.

1. Documentation

The 2022 questionnaire serves as reference for the 2022 PUMF data file. The questionnaire will display additional questions that are not represented in the PUMF due to suppressions and other restriction methods that have been applied to the data.

The 2022 PUMF data dictionary does not include the corresponding question names which can be found in the questionnaire.

2. Conversion of 2022 Master File to Public Use Microdata File (PUMF)

The approach for creating a PUMF is intended to balance the requirements for maintaining respondent confidentiality by minimizing disclosure risks, while providing the most useful data to users at the health region level. The following paragraphs outline some of the procedures applied to convert the CCHS master file into a PUMF.

Geography: Health regions fall under provincial jurisdiction and are used as the basis for the sample design of the CCHS. There are 107 health regions across Canada (see section 5.2 and Appendix B of the User Guide).

Some health regions have population sizes that were considered to be too small to appear individually in the PUMFs. These health regions were grouped with other(s) for the purpose of publication. The approach for keeping or collapsing health region geography in the PUMF entails applying a minimum population size for the given geography – 70, 000 inhabitants. This resulted in:

- i. collapsing 25 HRs into 12 health region groupings in Newfoundland and Labrador, New Brunswick, Ontario, Manitoba, Saskatchewan, and British Columbia;
- ii. one Quebec HR (Nord-du-Québec, 2410) being excluded from the PUMF due to its small population size and its demographic characteristics that did not lend itself well to being collapsed with other HRs;
- iii. The territories (Yukon, Nunavut, and the Northwest Territories) have sample sizes too small to appear individually in the PUMFs. Thus, the territories were grouped together for the purpose of publication.

After the grouping of HR, the CCHS PUMF is comprised of 91 HRs/HR groupings across the country. The list of regions before and after collapsing is available in section 5 of this document.

Optional content suppression: Because optional content selection in CCHS is done at the provincial and territorial levels, with the grouping of the territories it becomes necessary to adjust the optional content. If an optional module was included in at least one, but not all three territories, this data cannot be kept on the PUMF. Only optional content that was selected by all three can be kept.

Disclosure control: As mentioned earlier, the 2022 PUMF is designed to preserve the analytical value of data as much as possible while ensuring the potential for identifying individual respondents is minimal. Several controls were implemented in creating the PUMF. Restriction methods such as removing direct identifiers (e.g., sample ID, name, telephone number), reducing, recoding, and/or suppressing detail based on small frequencies given specific

socio-demographic characteristics were used. Examples of variables from the master file that were not included in the PUMF due to a high risk of disclosure (either because the variable is a risk on its own or is so in combination with other variables) include: attempted suicide in the past 12 months, used ecstasy in lifetime, and whether the respondent is presently pregnant.

In addition, some response categories were deemed to be at possible risk of disclosure and were regrouped so as to be included on the PUMF. Examples include: employment status, cardiovascular conditions, BMI status, number of years since stopping smoking, and main source of household income. With these regroupings in place, the 2022 PUMF contains both fewer variables and is less detailed compared with the master file, while still preserving the analytical value of the data.

Age of respondent: Respondents' age is provided as age grouping in the CCHS PUMFs. These groupings follow the sample allocation design for CCHS. The following age groups are available on the 2022 CCHS PUMF:

- i) 12 to 17 years
- ii) 18 to 34 years
- iii) 35 to 49 years
- iv) 50 to 64 years
- v) 65 and older

Although information on some variables were collected for people of a specific age bracket, some data for certain ages still had to be suppressed to ensure confidentiality. For example, labour force data were collected for respondents aged 15 to 75. Because there is an age group limitation of 65 years and older on the PUMF, publishing labour force data for 65 to 75 year olds would reveal more detail about their age within the 65+ group. Therefore, labour force data (LBF) and some main activity data (MAC) are only available on the PUMFs for respondents aged 18-64 (similar treatment is applied for the 15-17 year old respondents).

3. Bootstrap Weights for the PUMF

The 2022 PUMF includes bootstrap weights which are disseminated for users to estimate variances. For confidentiality reasons, the bootstrap weights for the public-use-microdata-file (PUMF) are not generated using the same methodology as for the CCHS master and share files. All bootstrap weights on the PUMF are strictly positive.

Also note that due to the removal of one health region from the PUMF, the sums of bootstrap weights by replicate are not exactly equal. The effect on the variance is negligible.

4. Content

The CCHS content can be divided into two categories, optional content and common content modules.

Optional content

The optional content component is designed to give provinces and territories the opportunity to select content that addresses their own public health priorities.

Common content

As mentioned in sections 4.1 and 4.2 of the User Guide, common content modules include questions asked of all respondents.

5. Health Region Groupings

The 2022 Master file 107 health regions have been grouped into 91 health regions for the PUMF. These groupings are detailed below. The PUMF health regions (variable GEODGHR4) are similar to what was produced for previous years.

Health regions for dissemination, before PUMF

Newfoundland and Labrador (Integrated Health Authority)

1011	Eastern Regional Integrated Health Authority
1012	Central Regional Integrated Health Authority
1013	Western Regional Integrated Health Authority
1014	Labrador-Grenfell Regional Integrated Health Authority

Prince Edward Island

1100	Prince Edward Island
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Nova Scotia

1201	Zone 1 - Western
1202	Zone 2 - Northern
1203	Zone 3 - Eastern
1204	Zone 4 - Central

New Brunswick

1301	Zone 1 (Moncton area)
1302	Zone 2 (Saint John area)
1303	Zone 3 (Fredericton area)
1304	Zone 4 (Edmundston area)
1305	Zone 5 (Campbellton area)
1306	Zone 6 (Bathurst area)
1307	Zone 7 (Miramichi area)

Quebec

2401	Région du Bas-Saint-Laurent
2402	Région du Saguenay—Lac-Saint-Jean
2403	Région de la Capitale-Nationale
2404	Région de la Mauricie et du Centre-du-Québec
2405	Région de l'Estrie
2406	Région de Montréal
2407	Région de l'Outaouais
2408	Région de l'Abitibi-Témiscamingue
2409	Région de la Côte-Nord
2410	Région du Nord-du-Québec
2411	Région de la Gaspésie—Îles-de-la-Madeleine
2412	Région de la Chaudière-Appalaches
2413	Région de Laval
2414	Région de Lanaudière
2415	Région des Laurentides
2416	Région de la Montérégie

Health regions for PUMF

Newfoundland and Labrador (Integrated Health Authority)

10911	Eastern Regional Integrated Health Authority
10912	Central Regional Integrated Health Authority
10913	Western/Labrador-Grenfell Regional IHA

Prince Edward Island

11901	Prince Edward Island
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Nova Scotia

12901	Zone 1 - Western
12902	Zone 2 - Northern
12903	Zone 3 - Eastern
12904	Zone 4 - Central

New Brunswick

13901	Zone 1 (Moncton area)
13902	Zone 2 (Saint John area)
13903	Zone 3 (Fredericton area)
13904	Zones 4 and 5 (Edmundston and Campbellton)
13906	Zones 6 and 7 (Bathurst and Miramichi)

Quebec

24901	Région du Bas-Saint-Laurent
24902	Région du Saguenay—Lac-Saint-Jean
24903	Région de la Capitale-Nationale
24904	Région de la Mauricie et du Centre-du-Québec
24905	Région de l'Estrie
24906	Région de Montréal
24907	Région de l'Outaouais
24908	Région de l'Abitibi-Témiscamingue
24909	Région de la Côte-Nord
	N/A – dropped from PUMF
24911	Région de la Gaspésie—Îles-de-la-Madeleine
24912	Région de la Chaudière-Appalaches
24913	Région de Laval
24914	Région de Lanaudière
24915	Région des Laurentides
24916	Région de la Montérégie

Health regions for dissemination, before PUMF

Ontario (Health Unit)

3526	The District of Algoma Health Unit
3527	Brant County Health Unit
3530	Durham Regional Health Unit
3533	Grey Bruce Health Unit
3534	Haldimand-Norfolk Health Unit
3535	Haliburton, Kawartha, Pine Ridge District Health Unit
3536	Halton Regional Health Unit
3537	City of Hamilton Health Unit
3538	Hastings and Prince Edward Counties Health Unit
3539	Huron County Health Unit
3554	Perth District Health Unit
3540	Chatham-Kent Health Unit
3541	Kingston, Frontenac and Lennox and Addington HU
3542	Lambton Health Unit
3543	Leeds, Grenville and Lanark District Health Unit
3544	Middlesex-London Health Unit
3546	Niagara Regional Area Health Unit
3547	North Bay Parry Sound District Health Unit
3563	Timiskaming Health Unit
3549	Northwestern Health Unit
3556	Porcupine Health Unit
3551	City of Ottawa Health Unit
3553	Peel Regional Health Unit
3555	Peterborough County–City Health Unit
3557	Renfrew County and District Health Unit
3558	The Eastern Ontario Health Unit
3560	Simcoe Muskoka District Health Unit
3561	Sudbury and District Health Unit
3562	Thunder Bay District Health Unit
3565	Waterloo Health Unit
3566	Wellington-Dufferin-Guelph Health Unit
3568	Windsor-Essex County Health Unit
3570	York Regional Health Unit
3575	Oxford Elgin St. Thomas Health Unit
3595	City of Toronto Health Unit

Manitoba

4601	Winnipeg Regional Health Authority
4602	Prairie Mountain Health
4603	Interlake-Eastern Regional Health Authority
4604	Northern Regional Health Authority
4605	Southern Health—Santé Sud

Health regions for PUMF

Ontario (Health Unit)

35926	The District of Algoma Health Unit
35927	Brant County Health Unit
35930	Durham Regional Health Unit
35933	Grey Bruce Health Unit
35934	Haldimand-Norfolk Health Unit
35935	Haliburton, Kawartha, Pine Ridge District Health Unit
35936	Halton Regional Health Unit
35937	City of Hamilton Health Unit
35938	Hastings and Prince Edward Counties Health Unit
35939	Huron/Perth Health Unit
35940	Chatham-Kent Health Unit
35941	Kingston, Frontenac and Lennox and Addington HU
35942	Lambton Health Unit
35943	Leeds, Grenville and Lanark District Health Unit
35944	Middlesex-London Health Unit
35946	Niagara Regional Area Health Unit
35947	North Bay Parry Sound/Timiskaming Health Unit
35949	Northwestern/Porcupine Health Unit
35951	City of Ottawa Health Unit
35953	Peel Regional Health Unit
35955	Peterborough County–City Health Unit
35957	Renfrew County and District Health Unit
35958	The Eastern Ontario Health Unit
35960	Simcoe Muskoka District Health Unit
35961	Sudbury and District Health Unit
35962	Thunder Bay District Health Unit
35965	Waterloo Health Unit
35966	Wellington-Dufferin-Guelph Health Unit
35968	Windsor-Essex County Health Unit
35970	York Regional Health Unit
35975	Oxford Elgin St. Thomas Health Unit
35995	City of Toronto Health Unit

Manitoba

46901	Winnipeg Regional Health Authority
46902	Prairie Mountain Health
46903	Interlake-Eastern/Northern Regional Health Authority
46905	Southern Health—Santé Sud

Health regions for dissemination, before PUMF

Saskatchewan (Regional Health Authority)

4701 Sun Country RHA
4702 Five Hills RHA
4703 Cypress RHA
4704 Regina Qu'Appelle RHA
4705 Sunrise RHA
4708 Kelsey Trail RHA
4706 Saskatoon RHA
4707 Heartland RHA
4710 Prairie North RHA
4709 Prince Albert Parkland RHA
4714 Mamawetan/Keewatin/Athabasca

Alberta

4831 South Zone
4832 Calgary Zone
4833 Central Zone
4834 Edmonton Zone
4835 North Zone

British Columbia

5911 East Kootenay Health Service Delivery Area
5912 Kootenay-Boundary Health Service Delivery Area
5913 Okanagan Health Service Delivery Area
5914 Thompson/Cariboo Health Service Delivery Area
5921 Fraser East Health Service Delivery Area
5922 Fraser North Health Service Delivery Area
5923 Fraser South Health Service Delivery Area
5931 Richmond Health Service Delivery Area
5932 Vancouver Health Service Delivery Area
5933 North Shore/Coast Garibaldi Health Service Delivery Area
5941 South Vancouver Island Health Service Delivery Area
5942 Central Vancouver Island Health Service Delivery Area
5943 North Vancouver Island Health Service Delivery Area
5951 Northwest Health Service Delivery Area
5953 Northeast Health Service Delivery Area
5952 Northern Interior Health Service Delivery Area

Territories

6001 Yukon
6101 Northwest Territories
6201 Nunavut

Health regions for PUMF

Saskatchewan (Regional Health Authority)

47901 Sun Country/Five Hills/Cypress RHA
47904 Regina Qu'Appelle RHA
47905 Sunrise/Kelsey Trail RHA
47906 Saskatoon RHA
47907 Heartland/Prairie North RHA
47909 Prince Albert Parkland/Mamawetan-Keewatin-Athabaska RHA

Alberta

48931 South Zone
48932 Calgary Zone
48933 Central Zone
48934 Edmonton Zone
48935 North Zone

British Columbia

59911 East Kootenay Health Service Delivery Area
59912 Kootenay-Boundary Health Service Delivery Area
59913 Okanagan Health Service Delivery Area
59914 Thompson/Cariboo Health Service Delivery Area
59921 Fraser East Health Service Delivery Area
59922 Fraser North Health Service Delivery Area
59923 Fraser South Health Service Delivery Area
59931 Richmond Health Service Delivery Area
59932 Vancouver Health Service Delivery Area
59933 North Shore/Coast Garibaldi Health Service Delivery Area
59941 South Vancouver Island Health Service Delivery Area
59942 Central Vancouver Island Health Service Delivery Area
59943 North Vancouver Island Health Service Delivery Area
59951 Northwest/Northeast
59952 Northern Interior Health Service Delivery Area

Territories

60901 Yukon/Northwest Territories/Nunavut